

Cruise Packing: What NOT to Bring

A quick, common-sense list of items that are **usually prohibited** (or heavily restricted) on most cruise lines. Always confirm with your cruise line for your exact sailing.

Fire & Heating Hazards

- Irons and portable steamers
- Hot plates, immersion heaters, coffee makers, kettles
- Candles, incense, wax warmers
- Heating pads, space heaters, electric blankets (often prohibited)
- Curling irons/flat irons may be allowed on many lines, but check your policy

Power & Electrical (Commonly Confiscated)

- Surge protectors and power strips with surge protection
- Extension cords
- High-wattage appliances and oversized chargers

Weapons & Look-Alikes

- Firearms, ammunition, BB/pellet guns
- Knives (including large pocketknives), pepper spray, stun devices
- Toy weapons or replicas that look real
- Self-defense keychains or sharp tactical tools

Illegal or Restricted Substances

- Illegal drugs or controlled substances without proper documentation
- Marijuana/THC products (including edibles and vapes) - often prohibited even where legal on land
- Open alcohol brought onboard beyond your cruise line's allowance

Hazardous Materials

- Flammable liquids (lighter fluid, gasoline) and aerosols beyond personal size
- Fireworks, sparklers, explosives
- Compressed gas cylinders (including some camping gear)
- Chemical cleaners or strong solvents

Electronics & Gadgets (Often Restricted)

- Drones (may be banned or restricted to ports only)
- Hoverboards and some lithium battery micromobility devices
- Two-way radios on some sailings
- Large speakers - sometimes restricted

Food, Beverages & Misc.

- Fresh fruits/vegetables/meat/dairy - restrictions vary by itinerary
- Heating food devices (mini-grills, toaster ovens)
- Items that violate local customs rules at ports

Travelholics Tip: If you're unsure, pack it in your suitcase and be ready for it to be held by security, or leave it at home. Confiscated items may not be returned until the end of the cruise (or at all).

Same goal. New level. And I'm rooting for you.

Ready for More? This guide covers the basics. For packing lists, budgeting tips, and insider strategies: Download the full Travelholics Cruise eBook. Created by Travelholics.